Fiscal Year:	FY 2014	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 09/27/2013
PI Name:	Cooper, Maya M.S.		
Project Title:	Effects of Processing and Subsequent Storage on Nutrition		
Division Name:	Human Research		
Program/Discipline:	HUMAN RESEARCH		
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	HUMAN RESEARCH--Space Human Factors Engineering		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	(1) **SHFH**:Space Human Factors & Habitability (archival in 2017)		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
PI Email:	maya.cooper@nasa.gov	**Fax:**	FY
PI Organization Type:	NASA CENTER	**Phone:**	281.483.1892
Organization Name:	Leidos/NASA Johnson Space Center		
PI Address 1:	1300 Hercules MC:C09		
PI Address 2:			
PI Web Page:			
City:	Houston	**State:**	TX
Zip Code:	77058	**Congressional District:**	22
Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	Directed Research
Start Date:	10/01/2008	**End Date:**	09/30/2015
No. of Post Docs:	0	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	0
No. of PhD Candidates:	0	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	0
No. of Master's Candidates:	1	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	0
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	0	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA JSC
Contact Monitor:	Douglas, Grace	**Contact Phone:**	
Contact Email:	grace.l.douglas@nasa.gov		
Flight Program:			
Flight Assignment:			
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:	No personnel changes within the last year. NOTE: Maya Cooper took over as PI, replacing Michele Perchonok, as of 10/1/2008. See Perchonok for FY2008 record. [Information per M. Perchonok/JSC]		
COI Name (Institution):	Koslovsky, Matthew (University of Texas Health Science Center)		
Grant/Contract No.:	Directed Research		
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			
	NASA has established the goal of returning human expeditions to the moon and extending exploration to Mars. The length of proposed Mars missions increases the importance of nutritional content in the food system. Proper nutrition is essential to prevent or mitigate some physiological effects of long-term space travel as well as maintain astronaut health. The purpose of this task is to evaluate the nutritional content of the existing International Space Station (ISS) and Shuttle food system for a mission to Mars by determining the effects of thermal processing, freeze drying, irradiation, and subsequent storage time on the nutritional content of the food. In order to insure the safety of the food system and in order to deactivate metabolic enzymes that may cause the food to spoil, the packaged foods are processed to commercial sterility. This level of processing can reduce the quality of the food including nutritional content and acceptability.		

Task Description:	There has been limited measurement of the nutritional content of the flight food items. Some macronutrients and minerals are determined chemically at the Johnson Space Center Water and Food Analytical Laboratory (WAFAL). However nutrients, such as vitamins, are currently only determined through a computer program, Food Processor (ESHA Research), which calculates the combined nutritional content based on the ingredients used in the food product's formulation. The computer program provides only a close approximation of the true nutrient content and does not take into account the loss of nutrients during the thermal, freeze drying, or irradiation processes. While kinetic data have been presented in the literature for the loss of nutrition during processing, the kinetic constants provided are specific to the food and the conditions in each test. Therefore, use of the data and kinetic models in the literature will only provide a rough estimate of remaining nutritional content. Fifteen to twenty-six processed food items will be selected per year for five years and an entire nutritional profile will be determined by an off-site laboratory on each of these products at three points of its shelf life – one month after processing, at 1 year, and at 3 years - until nutritional adequacy or a need for countermeasures is established. The one year time period was chosen because it is currently the average time after production that these food items are consumed on ISS and Shuttle missions. Food items will be selected for testing based on the importance of assumed nutritional content, frequency in the menus, and the type of food. Products will be stored at ambient conditions during the 3 year period to mimic the environmental storage conditions of the flight food. This study does not seek to address the effect of processing on nutrients in detail, but rather aims to place in context the overall nutritional status at the time of consumption. Data showing the effect of processing and subsequent storage will be of value pending the need to develop an "Adequate Food System" or institute countermeasures to provide health promoting foods for long duration manned space exploration.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	NASA Human Research Program research to determine the nutrient content of prepackaged space food over time will be the most comprehensive look to-date at the extent to which vitamins degrade in complex food dishes over multiple year periods. Manned space missions beyond low-Earth orbit require a food system that can maintain food quality for up to five years. The food should not only be acceptable in taste but retain much of the starting concentrations of vitamins. This study of 109 foods and 25 micronutrients over a 3-year product life is helping to identify the food factors that promote and/or inhibit vitamin sustainment in shelf stable food. The research has implications to the selection and formulation of relief food supplies and military rations that are commonly stored at ambient conditions for long periods before use. Populations that require these food stores generally have limited access to other food so it is desired that the food be as nutritious as possible.
Task Progress:	From 2008 – 2012, a total of 109 space foods were collected directly after processing and packaging and sent to a subcontracted laboratory to determine the post-stabilization content of 23 micronutrients. At the same time, duplicate samples of the food were placed in a 21°C environmental chamber for storage. After one year of storage and three years of storage passed, these duplicate samples were pulled from the chamber and sent to the subcontracted laboratory for repeat nutritional analysis. The addition of new menu items to the study as well as the one-year storage analysis have been completed. The completion of the one-year testing of all 109 foods marked a project milestone. The data shows vitamin A, vitamin C, thiamin, riboflavin, vitamin B6, and vitamin B12 had a statistically significant decline from the initial measure after production to the analysis at one-year of storage. Processing history, particularly thermostabilization, appeared to have an impact on vitamin stability even into storage. Vitamin stability was dependent upon the micronutrient and the food matrix. Even with the noted degradation, the one-year levels of nutritional quality in the space food system supplied most vitamins and minerals in excess of the recommended daily intake assuming intake followed the ISS standard menu. Only the four micronutrients that were deficient initially – potassium, calcium, vitamin K, and vitamin D - were inadequate after one year. Thiamin was the only new vitamin of concern after one year - those levels barely met the recommended daily intake for crewmembers. Heretofore, patterns of nutritional stability for the space food analyzed through three years of storage follows the degradation noted in the first year of storage. Hence, micronutrients which were stable in the first year in a particular food often show the same stability for the remaining years of the study. Alternatively, if a vitamin degraded in the first year, degradation continued. The remaining nutritional data expected in FY14 and FY15 will be used to verify this finding.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 04/23/2019)
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Cooper MR. "Initial Nutritional Quality of ISS Space Food Provisions." 2013 NASA Human Research Program Investigators' Workshop, Galveston, TX, February 12-14, 2013. 2013 NASA Human Research Program Investigators' Workshop, Galveston, TX, February 12-14, 2013. , Feb-2013
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Cooper MR. "The Initial Nutritional Quality Of International Space Station Food Provisions." 2013 Institute of Food Technologists Annual Meeting, Chicago, Illinois, July 13-16, 2013. 2013 Institute of Food Technologists Annual Meeting, Chicago, Illinois, July 13-16, 2013. , Jul-2013